

Authorization to Proceed with a Remedial Investigation/Feasibility Study
at the Northernnaire Plating Company, Cadillac, Wexford County, Michigan

William N. Hedeman, Jr., Director
Office of Emergency and Remedial Response (WH-548)

Lee M. Thomas, Acting Administrator
for Solid Waste and Emergency Response (WH-562A)

ACTION MEMORANDUM

This is a request to conduct a Remedial Investigation/Feasibility Study (RI/FS) at the Northernnaire Plating Company, Cadillac, Wexford County, Michigan (Northernnaire). The Michigan Department of Natural Resources (MDNR) intends to enter into a Cooperative Agreement (CA) to undertake these activities.

The Northernnaire site is on the National Priorities List dated December 30, 1982.

Northernnaire is an abandoned electroplating facility which operated between 1971 and 1981. The site is located approximately one-half mile northwest of the center of the City of Cadillac in an area of mixed residential, commercial and industrial facilities. Northernnaire is located one-fourth mile southwest of the City of Cadillac's municipal well field. The topography of the immediate area is flat and dominated by sandy soils.

The remedial investigation will confirm the source of contamination by determining its extent and severity. The remedial investigation will also identify on-site physical features and facilities that could affect contaminant migration, containment or cleanup. The RI/FS will determine if the site poses a significant health or environmental problem. Data will be collected to support the feasibility study and the final design. The feasibility study will be prepared to identify, evaluate and, if necessary, recommend implementation of remedial actions.

The MDNR inspected the site in May, 1981 and found the facility abandoned. Several drums containing plating wastes were left outside of the building. A child playing near the drums received serious chemical burns from the material contained in one of the drums. The property owner transferred the drums to the interior of the building upon the request of MDNR.

Presently, the Northernnaire building is padlocked with windows boarded to further prevent accidental access to the interior.

An Enforcement Release for Northernnaire is attached.

EPA Region 5 Records Ctr.



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Within the framework of the RI/FS we intend to conduct a Focused Feasibility Study to evaluate source control measures. A limited alternatives evaluation will be undertaken for all vats, drums and other containers at the site, including their contents and additional sludges on the floor of the building. Alternatives will be investigated to eliminate the likelihood of further groundwater and soil contamination due to runoff.

The estimated cost of the Remedial Investigation is \$300,000.00 and it is expected to require 40 weeks to complete. The estimated cost of the Feasibility Study is \$150,000.00 and is expected to require 10 weeks to complete. The United States Environmental Protection Agency will fund 100% of these activities, a total of \$450,000.00.

An Immediate Removal action is being considered for the Northernfaire site. This would include the removal of all liquids and sludges on site including their respective drums, vats and other containers. If necessary, the building and its slab will be decontaminated, the connection to the city sewer system will be removed, and soil around the building will be removed or decontaminated. Implementation of Immediate Removal actions would reduce the cost of the Remedial Investigation and mitigate the source of contamination.

Our office and EPA Headquarters have reviewed MDNR's draft CA and provided comments to the State of Michigan. We anticipate that the MDNR will submit a final CA by June 17, 1983.

This request has been coordinated with the appropriate Headquarters and Regional Offices. I recommend that you authorize the RI/FS at the Northernfaire site.

Approve _____

Disapprove _____

Date _____

KBANASZEK:kpB:Remedial Response Section I:5-31-83

SARPB
Vanderhaar
6/14/83

SARPB
R6LB
6/16/83

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ROF
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